

Javier Ponz Prado

Technical support · agent operations · a forward-deployed path · Aberdeen, Scotland

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Nous Research

Open application — an early-career path toward Forward Deployed Engineer

I have spent ten years helping people make difficult technology work. I am now applying that discipline to open agents, tools and systems, and I am building toward forward-deployed engineering at Nous — honestly, from the support side first.

Between 2014 and 2024 I worked across Apple Retail Spain as a Specialist, a Technical Specialist and, for six and a half years, a Genius, with a remote AppleCare Support Advisor period during COVID and two seven-month In-Store Experience Lead secondments. Most of that decade was hands-on diagnosis: separating symptom from cause, documenting what had been checked, and translating a technical system into a next step the person in front of me could act on.

What I can show today. I use Hermes Agent daily and build tooling, skills and workflows around it, giving agents explicit context and permissions and verifying what they return. Memento Mori is a small privacy-first web product I wrote and deployed to its own domain with Docker, Nginx and Traefik behind release checks. Hermes PKM Toolkit (MCP tools for local Markdown vaults, with path-traversal protection and tests) and OTH Hermes (an onboarding path for Hermes Agent) were specified by me and written with an agent. My portfolio labels which is which.

Where the gap is. I have not spent five years shipping enterprise software. I am still building depth in backend engineering, cloud and hybrid deployment, APIs and authentication, observability, networking and production agent infrastructure, and I am studying AI and Full Stack development through Universidad Rey Juan Carlos via Racks Academy (in progress). Kubernetes and container orchestration, deeper Python, and a homelab of my own now in design are what I am starting next — stated as intent rather than experience, learned with an LLM and an agent harness beside me and aimed at the part that makes a system operable. I am asking for the chance to close that gap in the direction of Forward Deployed Engineer, not for anyone to pretend it is closed.

I am based in Aberdeen, Scotland, work across UK and European time zones, can travel, would consider relocation, and can start immediately. The full application is at nousresearch.technoir.cloud. The most useful reply would tell me what would make me obviously useful to Nous in the first 90 days; I would rather close a specific gap than guess at one.

Thank you for reading.

Javier Ponz Prado